

EMMA RACKSTRAW

www.emmarackstraw.com

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Email: emma.rackstraw@gmail.com

Citizenship: USA

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

- Assistant Professor of Economics, Swarthmore College, August 2024-Present
- SSRC Criminal Justice Innovation Postdoctoral Fellow, Quattrone Center at UPenn Carey Law, AY2024-5

EDUCATION

- Harvard University, Ph.D. in Public Policy (Economics Track), 2024
- Wellesley College, B.A. in Economics (Major) and Music (Minor), 2014

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Labor economics, discrimination, crime, experiments, behavioral economics

WORKING PAPERS

- Who Watches the Watchers? How “Copaganda” Affects Police, Communities, and Viewers. Available at [SSRN](#).
- Bias-Motivated Updating in the Labor Market. Available at [SSRN](#).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- Background Check Adjudication & Fair Chance Hiring. (with Amanda Agan & David Autor)
- Sticky Stereotypes: Manager Identity & the Workplace. (with Anna Gifty Opoku-Agyeman)

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

- 2025: J-PAL Social Policy Research Initiative*, Russell Sage Foundation*
- 2024: Center for Black Entrepreneurship Research Fellowship*
- 2023: Program in Criminal Justice Grantee, Stone Program in Wealth Distribution, Inequality, and Social Policy Research Grantee, Institute for Quantitative Social Science Grantee, Academy of Management Doctoral Consortium Scholarship, Women and Public Policy Program Grantee*
- 2021: ReSTAT Research Grantee, Mind Brain Behavior Initiative Grantee
- 2020: HKS Wiener Center for Social Policy Pilot Grantee; Peggy Howard Fellowship for Graduate Study in Economics; Radcliffe Engaged Summer Grantee
- 2019: National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program

- 2014: Natalie Bolton Faculty Prize in International Economics; Phi Beta Kappa

*Co-author PI

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Affiliations: J-PAL NA Invited Researcher

Invited Seminars:

- 2025: Lafayette College
- 2024: Minneapolis Fed Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Initiative (OIGI), Penn Criminology Colloquium, Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE)
- 2023: HKS Economics and Social Policy, Wellesley Initiative for Scholars of Economics (WISE)

External Conferences and Workshops:

- 2025: J-PAL NA Convening on Effective US Crime Policy, Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars (Co-Organizer), Quattrone Center Spring Symposium, American Economic Association Meeting (AEA)
- 2024: Society of Labor Economists (SOLE)*, Liberal Arts College Public & Labor (LAC-PaL), National Bureau of Economic Research Summer Institute (NBERSI), SABE-IAREP, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (TWEC)*, PPE Society, American Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)*
- 2023: AEA, Western Economic Association International Meeting (WEAI), NBERSI, Academy of Management Meeting (AoM), APPAM
- 2022: Texas Economics of Crime Workshop (TxECW)
- 2019: Association of American Law Schools (AALS)
- 2018: APPAM

*Co-Author Presenting

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee Service: Quarterly Journal of Economics, The Review of Economics & Statistics, Journal of Public Economics, Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Justice Quarterly, Journal of Criminal Justice, Management Science.

Professional Service Positions: Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars Co-Organizer (2024-2025), Kennedy School PhD Students' Association President (2021-2022), PhD Peer Mentor (2020-2024), HKS Anti-Racism in Economics Founding Member (2020-2022), Organizer of Economics of Discrimination Reading Group (2020-2021)

TEACHING

Teaching Interests: Labor Economics, Economics of Crime, Microeconomics, Econometrics, Experimental Economics, Academic Writing, Causal Inference, Discrimination

Teaching Experience:

- Empirical Methods II for MPPs, Harvard Kennedy School, 2021

- Evaluation Course for Chief Evaluation Officers, Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
- Executive Education Course in Randomized Evaluation, J-PAL at MIT, 2019
- Econometrics for Undergraduates, Wellesley College, 2013

PREVIOUS EMPLOYMENT

- Research Assistant for Will Dobbie, Harvard Kennedy School, 2019 - 2022
- Research Consultant
 - PDQuery (unpaid), 2022-2024
 - Crime and Justice Policy Lab, University of Pennsylvania, 2021-2024
 - Everytown for Gun Safety, 2018-19
- Associate Fellow (Academic IPA), Office of Evaluation Sciences, 2019
- Senior Policy Associate, J-PAL North America at MIT, 2016 - 2019
- Research Economist, Council of Economic Advisers at the White House, 2014 - 2016

SKILLS

Data & Software: Stata (Advanced), R (Proficient), L^AT_EX(Proficient), Zotero (Proficient), Excel (Proficient), Python (Basic)

Languages: English (Native), French (Proficient), Spanish (Basic)

Talents: Singing (Semi-Professional), Glassblowing (Amateur)

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Prison Volunteer in PA (2022-present) and MA (2017-2020), Providence Animal Center Volunteer (2025-present), Morris Animal Refuge Volunteer (2022-2025), Meals on Wheels Volunteer (2020-2023)